

SHOULD WE COMPENSATE FOR THE HISTORICAL WRONGDOINGS OF OUR NATION OR ANCESTORS?

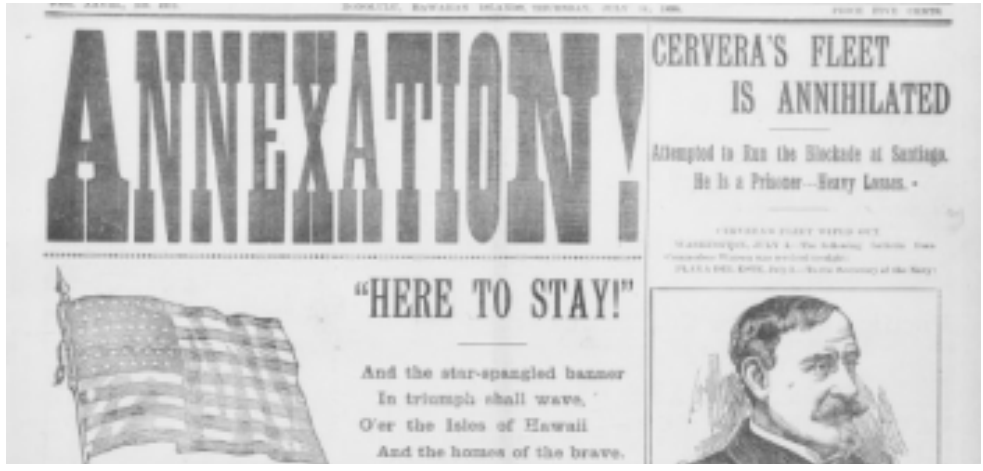
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BRAINSTORM

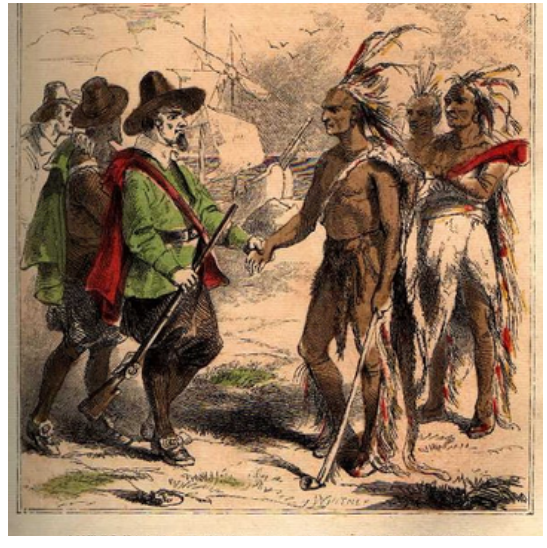
What are historical wrongdoings?











Source 1

Reparation

Does any person or group of people have a **right to reparations**?

Does the right to reparation die with the victim, or can it persist across generations?

September 4, 2025 12:00AM EDT | Q & A

Available In English Français

Q&A: Reparations for Historical and Ongoing Colonial Atrocities



Hundreds of people of African descent took part in the African Emancipation Day Reparations March in London, August 1, 2017. © 2017 Wiktor Szymanowicz/Shutterstock

In this Q&A, Human Rights Watch examines the application of the right to reparation to redress past and present harms stemming from colonial atrocities, including enslavement,[1] systemic racial inequalities, and other related human rights violations. It examines the right globally, not specific to one geographic or historical context.

The term "reparations" refers to the right under international human rights law to a remedy for those who have been harmed. The term "reparatory justice" is intrinsically linked with the right to reparations and refers to a broader, more comprehensive approach that addresses the root causes of harm and systemic inequalities to seek broader social and political change.

Source 2

"paying reparations to all descendants of slaves is a mistake"

Does **moral obligation** to give reparations extend beyond those who directly caused harm?

Coleman Hughes

Opening Statement on Slavery Reparations to the U.S. House Committee on the Judiciary

delivered 19 June 2019, Washington, D.C.



Source: Opening Statement on Slavery Reparations to the U.S. House Committee on the Judiciary

Source 2

"paying reparations to all descendants of slaves is a mistake"

Who bears the duty to pay reparations? Individuals? Beneficiary? Nations?

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Additional Case

Affirmative Action

Can groups bear moral responsibility even if individual members are innocent?



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HuUDhfKV3bk

***SFFA v. Harvard*:**

- Majority Opinion: Justice Roberts wrote that the 14th Amendment's Equal Protection Clause applies "without regard to any difference of race, of color, or of nationality." "Eliminating racial discrimination means eliminating all of it...".[56]



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Question Jar

Let us know what questions, comments, feedback you have

